

Smartden

Smarthome services

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Q Can you tell us a bit about the company and how it started and what is the mission?

Niyati: We started in June last year, with our official registration happened on the first of June. In terms of the mission, it is actually to increase the adoption of smarthomes in India. So, right now adoption is in a nascent stage and people are still hesitant to convert their homes into a smarthome. We actually want that whole process to be easier and easily adaptable to people.

Q What kind of services do you offer?

Niyati: We are building an app, which can connect to the devices of multiple manufacturers, and all of it can be controlled from one single application. Parallely, to increase the adaptability and to increase the number of smarthomes, we also provide services in terms of consultation on what smart devices the customer require in a smarthome, whether they require lights or switches, or any of the other devices available. We have partnered with around fifteen brands and we provide the consultation for their product portfolios, and we do the installation as well. Then, we also provide the after installation services. We actually work with the OEMs. and we do not manufacture our own products.

Q What happens if people already have some smart devices?

Niyati: It depends on the brands actually. We are trying to build the app in a way that it can control most of the smart devices. We are also partnering with multiple brands to enable that kind of compatibility. If the consumer has already purchased some smarthome devices, lights for example, and they are looking for switches for the rest of the smart devices, we are happy to provide that facility to the customers as well.

Q Is the app platform agnostic?

Divyateja: Yes, we are agnostic in that sense, and we are building the app on both iOS and Android. However, the Android app will be launching first, followed up with the iOS release. We are not working on other platforms.

Q The users have to switch between multiple apps to use all the devices, are you trying to solve that problem?

Divyateja: You are absolute correct. That is where we come into the picture. That is exactly what we are planning to do. The major thing that we are working on is the interoperability and the features which do not depend on the brand. So it does not affect the user experience if the device is brand A or brand B, the features that we build on will work on any of the brands, and the user does not have to switch between apps. We work on directly interfacing with the products of as many brands as we can.

Q IoT devices are notorious for security issues, and vulnerable to DDoS attacks, so what is your approach to security?

Divyateja: The security problem with the IoT devices is that majority of the devices get affected through DDoS attacks, that is absolutely right. That's the big challenge that everybody faces irrespective of the network protocols that the manufacturer uses. There is what we call the heartbeat data that is being transmitted continuously by the device just to know the status of the device, which keeps on traversing between the networks. Anybody who is around the home or inside the home will be able to actually see and detect the heartbeat data which is being transmitted by the device. Now, this is a challenge as there is not much that we can do on that aspect, however, there are a lot of things that we are doing on our front. These kind of attacks happen if you are keeping a weak password in our network routers, that is the first thing to start with. If we have an open network, then that is the biggest challenge. We ensure that the WiFi network is not shared openly in the home, and there is a method of passwords that we are applying. That is the first step for a DDoS attack, where you get into the network first and then you can see the protocol which is being sent across. So our first step, when we do the services as Niyati mentioned, we create a mesh network which is a secured network, which is isolated basically. There are specific mesh based IoT routers that we work on, and those routers can support two different networks within the same IP address range that you create within a home. So basically, with the one router that you have in the home, you can create two different networks, one will be an isolated network which will be used only for the client devices, which can



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